

Sam Freedman

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Forest data scientist and natural resource professional with advanced training in geospatial analysis, remote sensing, forest policy/modeling + landscape design →

Professional Experience

San Francisco State University

Graduate teaching assistant

San Francisco, CA

Jan 2025–Present

- Lecture and lead labs for 50+ undergraduates on climate science, policy, and environmental data analysis.
- Advise students and support curriculum development focused on applied data skills.

Forest Bridges

Forest Policy Analyst

Remote/Roseburg, OR

June 2020–Jan 2025

- Conducted technical literature reviews and spatial analysis to support BLM forest policy on 2.5 + million acres in Oregon.
- Developed GIS StoryMaps translating ecological forest management and wildfire mitigation strategies for policymakers.
- Coordinated with Tribes, agencies, and NGOs to synthesize technical input for climate-adapted forest policy frameworks.
- Contributed to legislative advocacy for prescribed fire and forest-health incentives through Oregon Prescribed Fire Council.

Carbonfuture

Forest sustainability consultant

Remote

Jan 2023–April 2023

- Researched Bolivian forestry practices and carbon-market standards (FSC, ABT) to assess project eligibility for CO₂ removal credits.
- Synthesized Spanish-language policy documents and satellite data to evaluate biochar supply chain sustainability.
- Supported vetting of a multi-million-ton carbon removal project via technical due diligence and stakeholder interviews.

Oregon State University

Graduate teaching assistant

Corvallis, OR

Sept 2019–May 2021

- Conducted daily lectures to groups of up to 50 undergraduate students on introductory forest topics like dendrology, forest biology, forests and wildfire, and conservation.

The Conway School, Northampton, MA — *Land Designer*

SEPT 2017 - JUNE 2018

- Designed resilience plans for two municipal clients and a private landowner, applying GIS and ecological landscape principles to support climate adaptation and habitat projects.

Jubali, Boston, MA — *Co-founder & owner*

NOV 2013 - JAN 2016

- Directed operations for a regional organic beverage company; managed branding, design, and fundraising.

Skills

Spatial Analysis | ArcGIS Pro, Remote Sensing (ENVI, SNAP)

Programming & Stats | Python (NumPy, Pandas, Rasterio, GeoPandas), R, SPSS

Forest Modeling | Forest Vegetation Simulator (FVS)

Communication | Technical writing, ArcGIS StoryMaps, stakeholder engagement

Other | Adobe Creative Suite, Canva, MS Office, Spanish (proficient), Portuguese (fluent)

Education

San Francisco State University, San Francisco, CA — Master of Science, Geographic Information Science

AUG 2024 - MAY 2026

Focus on remote sensing, spatial statistics, and Python-based raster and vector analysis.

Relevant Coursework: GIS for Environmental Analysis (raster), GIS II (vector), Remote Sensing I & II, Programming for GIS (Python), Environmental Data Science (R), Spatial Modeling and Regression (SPSS)

Oregon State University, Corvallis, OR — Master of Forestry, Sustainable Forest Management

SEP 2019 - MAY 2021

Specialized in silviculture, forest ecology, and wildfire management emphasizing carbon, biodiversity, and restoration outcomes.

Conway School of Landscape Design, Northampton, MA — Master of Science, Ecological Design

SEP 2018 - JUNE 2019

Northeastern University, Boston, MA — Bachelor of Arts in Cultural Anthropology, minor in Portuguese

SEP 2008 - JUNE 2013